

Finish Level	Final Appearance	How to Achieve Result			Levels of Paint Finish Over Gypsum Board
		Joints and Interior Angles	Accessories and Fasteners	Surface	
5	Entire surface covered with: a.) Sheetrock Brand Primer Surfacer (TUFF-Hide) or b.) Skim coat of compound and ready to prime before decorating with scheduled paint	As in Level 4	As in Level 4	Sheetrock Brand Primer Surfacer (Tuff-Hide) or skim coat and prime with CGC First Coat Synco Brand Pre-Coat before painting or texturing	All appropriately prepared gypsum board surfaces shall have one coat of drywall primer applied to yield a properly painted surface. Two separate coats of topcoat material shall be applied over the drywall primer to yield a properly painted surface. Paint shall be applied to the mil film thickness and application conditions specified by the paint manufacturer. Note that this level is recommended where the best paint finish is required, such as under critical lighting conditions or when paints that have a glossy surface are used. Recommended with a Level 5 gypsum board finish as described in the "Recommended Levels of Gypsum Board Finish" (GA-214-96). This system, when combined with the Level 5 gypsum board finish is the most effective method to minimize joint and fastener photographing and provides the most uniform final finish.
4	No marks or ridges. Ready for priming, followed by wall coverings, flat paints or light textures	Two separate coats of compound over Level 2	Three separate coats of compound	Joints filled and smoothed a second time. Shall be primed with CGC First Coat before painting or texturing	All appropriately prepared gypsum board surfaces shall have one coat of drywall primer applied to yield a properly painted surface and one separate coat of topcoat material applied to a properly painted surface over the drywall primer. Paint shall be applied to the mil film thickness and application conditions specified by the paint manufacturer. Note that this is typically recommended for smooth surfaces not subject to critical lighting and areas having light to medium texture finishes (spray or hand applied over a primed gypsum board surface). Refer to Drywall Finishing Council document titled, "Recommended Specification For Preparation of Gypsum Board Surfaces Prior To Texture Application." When subjected to critical lighting, a Level 5 gypsum board finish as defined in GA-214-96 is recommended.

3	No marks or ridges. Ready for priming, to be followed by heavy texture	One separate coat of compound over Level 2	Two Separate coats of Compound	Joints filled and smooth. Shall be primed with CGC First Coat before painting or texturing	All appropriately prepared gypsum board surfaces shall have two separate coats of topcoat material applied to yield a properly painted surface. Paint shall be applied to the mil film thickness and application conditions specified by the paint manufacturer. Note that this is typically recommended for areas having textures (spray or hand applied) over a primed gypsum board surface and the area is not subject to critical lighting. Refer to Drywall Finishing Council document titled, "Recommended Specification For Preparation of Gypsum Board Surfaces Prior To Texture Application." When subjected to critical lighting, a Level 5 gypsum board finish as defined in GA-214-96 ("Recommended Levels of Gypsum Board Finish") is recommended.
2	Tool marks and ridges okay. Thin coating of compound covers tape; one coat compound over fastener heads	Tape embedded in compound and immediately wiped to leave a thin coating of compound over tape	One coat of compound	Free of excess compound	All appropriately prepared gypsum board surfaces shall have one coat of topcoat material applied to yield a uniform surface. Paint shall be applied to the mil film thickness and application conditions specified by the paint manufacturer. Note that the painted surface may not achieve uniform appearance, color or sheen, but shall be absent of defects caused by the painting contractor's workforce. This level is recommended where economy is of primary concern.
1	Tool marks and ridges acceptable	Tape embedded in compound	Optional - One Coat of Compound	Free of excess compound	a.) When final decoration is undetermined, all appropriately prepared gypsum board surfaces shall have one coat of drywall primer applied. Drywall primer shall be applied to the mil film thickness and application conditions specified by the primer manufacturer. or b.) When wallcoverings are to be applied, all appropriately prepared gypsum board surfaces shall have one coat of wallcovering primer applied. Wallcovering primer shall be applied to the mil film thickness and application conditions specified by the primer manufacturer.

0	Unfinished	None			No painting required
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